

TRAVIS HOKI

Senior Software Engineer

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Senior Frontend Engineer, Ads Creative | Reddit

Dear Hiring Manager,

Your posting names Cursor and Claude specifically as day-to-day tools, and that is not a stretch for me. It is literally how I already ship. I use Cursor AI and Claude Code every day in production work at Salesforce. I also have a small, real example of the harder problem behind this role. My Food Cards project takes a plain-English query and resolves it into structured filters, with schema-validated output so an ambiguous answer degrades gracefully instead of confusing the user. That is the same kind of problem as translating an AI-backed capability into something a user can understand and steer.

Why I think Reddit is awesome!

Reducing blank-canvas work is a real interaction design problem, not just a feature list. An advertiser needs to trust a recommendation enough to act on it, and that trust gets built through the interface: how a suggestion is framed, how easy it is to override, how clear the reasoning is. That is a genuinely interesting problem. It rewards someone who cares about the architecture underneath as much as the moment-to-moment experience.

Why you should think I am awesome!

I have a repeated pattern of shipping changes and proving them with data, not opinion. At Overstock, I A/B tested a mobile Add to Cart flow and a rating-only review type. Both won on conversion. I have also led frontend architecture and standards work. I architected internationalization infrastructure from scratch at Spiff. I drove company-wide TypeScript adoption at Salesforce. I authored the frontend standards adopted across the whole engineering org at XANT. I mentor through pairing and code review, and I have ADA accessibility work at Overstock to back up the usability side of this role.

Why we would be awesome together!

I like owning ambiguous problems independently, from technical design through launch, which is how I approached the i18n work at Spiff with no playbook to follow. I do not have ad-tech experience specifically, but I have spent years building complex business applications: commission software at Spiff, sales tooling at XANT, and a high-traffic retail platform at Overstock. I am comfortable picking up a new domain quickly, and I have done it repeatedly across my career.

Sincerely,
Travis Hoki

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 14+ years of experience building, scaling, and modernizing web applications. Frontend specialist in React and TypeScript who uses Cursor AI and Claude Code daily in production development, not as a novelty but as how I actually ship. I have a proven, repeated pattern of experimentation: features I A/B tested at Overstock won on conversion, not on opinion. I also have hands-on experience translating an AI model's raw capability into an interface people can understand and refine: my Food Cards project resolves natural-language queries into structured filters, with schema-validated output so ambiguous responses degrade gracefully instead of breaking the UI. Joined Spiff as an early frontend engineer and stayed through its acquisition by Salesforce.

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **AI-Assisted Development:** Claude Code, Cursor AI, AI-assisted production development
- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Sass/SCSS, Less, PHP, Python, SQL, Ruby
- **Frontend:** React, React Native, Redux, AngularJS, jQuery, Handlebars, Lexical, Storybook, Server-Side Rendering (SSR), Responsive UI, Internationalization (i18n/l10n), Accessibility
- **Backend & Data:** Node.js, Express, Django, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Firebase/Firestore, GraphQL, REST APIs and API integration, Stripe
- **Testing & Code Quality:** Jest, Vitest, React Testing Library, Cypress, TDD, ESLint (custom rule sets), Prettier, Stylelint, Husky pre-commit hooks, coverage enforcement
- **Build & Platform:** Webpack, Vite, Git/GitHub, CI automation, AWS S3, WordPress/WooCommerce

WORK HISTORY

Senior Member of the Technical Staff – **Salesforce** (Mar. 2024 – May 2026)

Stayed on for two years after Salesforce acquired Spiff in March 2024, scaling the product for enterprise accounts.

- Raised the frontend codebase to Salesforce's post-acquisition quality standards, expanding Jest coverage and establishing strict ESLint rule sets. That work drove company-wide TypeScript adoption.
- Adopted Claude Code and Cursor AI into daily development, pair programming with them on refactors, debugging, and test-coverage work.
- Shipped a document composer on the Lexical editor framework after evaluating several WYSIWYG options, customizing it heavily for document workflows. Added a Handlebars-style merge-field system that resolves placeholders to live profile values at render time. Extended the server-side Ruby layer to customize PDF output.

Frontend Engineer – **Spiff**, acquired by Salesforce (Aug. 2021 – Mar. 2024)

Built core platform infrastructure at the startup, through to acquisition.

- Architected the frontend internationalization infrastructure from the ground up and migrated thousands of hardcoded strings across the application. Launched the product in Japanese, Spanish, and additional locales, supporting a major expansion priority for Spiff and Salesforce.
- Created a pseudo-localization tool that became the team's standard pre-merge check for untranslated UI. It renders every translated string as X's, letting any engineer spot gaps in seconds.
- Wrote custom automated tooling scripts (dead-code detection, unused-export pruning, lint enforcement) that systematically drove down technical debt across the repository.
- Designed a recursive component tree that renders company org hierarchies at any depth, powering team-based commission structures for enterprise accounts.
- Developed features against GraphQL APIs and practiced TDD, writing Jest and React Testing Library specs before implementation.

Senior Software Engineer – **XANT**, formerly *InsideSales.com* (Dec. 2020 – Aug. 2021)

- Authored the frontend architectural standards adopted across the engineering organization, defining code conventions, lint rules, and component structure.
- Mentored mid-level and junior developers through pair programming, working alongside them on their own projects to unblock delivery and grow their skills.
- Modernized legacy frontend architecture and JavaScript patterns, improving runtime performance and reducing ongoing maintenance burden.

Web Developer – **Chatbooks** (Mar. 2019 – Aug. 2020)

- Rebuilt the book creation flow, one of the company's core revenue paths, in React. Unlocked Premium Layflat book creation on desktop, giving customers a far better large-format editing experience.

- Executed a progressive, zero-downtime migration from legacy AngularJS to React across the customer-facing site, preserving production stability throughout.
- Built Cards taxonomy pages with category browsing and search filters using Node.js server-side rendering, accelerating page loads and improving SEO discoverability.
- Implemented Branch deep links and platform-specific quick-flow screens routing customers from Instagram's storefront into the iOS and Android apps.

Front-End Developer – Overstock.com, now Bed Bath & Beyond (Sept. 2015 – Mar. 2019)

- Owned the frontend for all User Generated Content on a high-traffic national e-commerce site: ratings, reviews, customer photos, and Q&A. Brought these templates into ADA accessibility compliance.
- Launched customer review images end to end, validating and formatting uploads client-side before pushing to AWS S3. Real customer photos let shoppers see products in use before buying.
- Led the site-wide migration of star ratings behind feature flags, coordinating simultaneous multi-department deploys. Introduced rating-only reviews, measurably increasing review volume.
- Rebuilt the responsive See All Reviews page and embedded a reusable React Add To Cart module into the mobile review flow. A two-week A/B test showed conversion lift.
- Delivered an internal SEO admin portal (React, Redux, Node.js, Express) letting business users manage SEO titles and taxonomy display names.
- Ported featured-product logic into an AMP search page using amp-bind, optimizing CSS to meet strict AMP size limits. Rearchitected a WordPress plugin into the embeddable affiliate-links widget that launched the affiliate program.

Full Stack Developer – Room Choice (Dec. 2014 – Aug. 2015)

- Developed full-stack features for student-housing management software using AngularJS/CoffeeScript on the frontend and Python/Django with PostgreSQL on the backend.
- Optimized queries, reporting, and application performance as the platform scaled to a rapidly growing number of students and institutional accounts.
- Designed and integrated the RESTful APIs between frontend and backend layers, collaborating with an international, distributed engineering team.

Custom Developer – Enspark (Nov. 2011 – Dec. 2014)

- Rebuilt the company's Learning Management System in PHP, MySQL, JavaScript, and jQuery, implementing user-account progress tracking across the eLearning catalog.
- Built custom web applications and features for small-business clients, spanning design, frontend, backend, and WordPress theme development.
- Produced interactive eLearning courses and marketing banners in Adobe Flash using ActionScript 3.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Food Cards – React, TypeScript, Firebase, Anthropic Claude API | food-cards.travishoki.com

A safe-foods catalog built for my son, who has food avoidance issues. Integrated Claude via the Anthropic SDK (@anthropic-ai/sdk) so users filter the collection in plain English. "Easy breakfast ideas" resolves to category, difficulty, sort order, and keyword filters at once. Prompt engineering enforces schema-validated JSON, so ambiguous output degrades gracefully rather than breaking the UI. Also implemented scored fuzzy search.

Hoki Skateboards Website – PHP, WordPress, WooCommerce, JavaScript, Stripe | hokiskateboards.com

Founded a skateboard company selling skateboards, apparel, and a self-published children's book. Designed the brand and built the storefront on a custom WordPress theme, with WooCommerce and Stripe handling retail and checkout.

Hoki Skateboards App – React Native, TypeScript, React Native Game Engine, Matter.js, Firebase | hokiskateboards.com/app

Designed, illustrated, and built a mobile game in React Native, shipping one codebase to iOS and Android as real native UI. Published on the [Apple App Store](https://apps.apple.com) and [Google Play Store](https://play.google.com).

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Digital Media (Emphasis in Internet Technology) – Utah Valley University

Associate in Applied Science, Digital Communication Technology – Utah Valley University

BEYOND ENGINEERING

Illustrator and self-published author of two children's books, one Kickstarter-funded. Improv Broadway stand-up comedy graduate and volunteer Cub Scouts den leader.

PORTFOLIO

TravisHoki.com – React, TypeScript, Vite, Storybook, Jest/Vitest | travishoki.com

Check out my portfolio to see this work in detail: case studies, screenshots, and write-ups for the projects above plus 20+ more from across my career.